

Causey source permission outreach

Who to ask, what to ask for, what a written yes must cover

Causey

September 6, 2026

Use: asking organizers for written permission to index public listings

Not: a partnership announcement, a scraper backlog, or a promise that any feed will go live

Product: Causey (<https://causey.dev>)

Related: `ingestion/README.md`, `lib/ingestion-sources.ts`, `lib/category-discovery.ts`

Use this when asking organizers for written permission to index their public listings on Causey. Chess search is already usable (US Chess TLA and related feeds). Debate, STEM, arts, and writing stay thin until the bodies below say yes—or until a first-party page is clearly allowed without a license (see “Confirm before building,” not the blocked list).

Do not scrape a blocked source while an email is in flight. A verbal “sounds fine” is not enough to turn automation on.

What we ask to index

Only **factual listing metadata**, with a link back to the official page:

- Event or program name
- Official canonical URL
- Published dates / status (open, closed, tentative)
- Category and published format (for example Public Forum, Division C)
- Online vs in-person, and published city/state or “online”
- Eligibility and fee **only if the public page already states them**

We do **not** ask for, and will not take:

- Logins, membership-only calendars, or behind-the-wall PDFs
- Ballots, pairings, speaker points, contest problems, solutions, or results dumps
- Student, coach, or judge personal data
- Logos or marks (attribution is a text name + link unless brand use is granted separately)
- Registration checkout, payment, or tab-room software features
- Cloudflare or other access-control bypasses

- Implied endorsement (“official Causey partner of ...”)

Cadence if they say yes: polite, sequential fetches (about twice weekly), identifiable user agent, fail closed if the page changes or robots/terms later forbid it.

What written permission must say

Keep the reply as email or a signed note. Engineering will not flip a kill switch on a hallway conversation. A usable yes includes:

1. **Who** is granting it (organization name, person’s role, date).
2. **What** we may copy: public tournament/program listings (name, dates, location or online, eligibility/fees if published, official URL).
3. **Where** we may show it: Causey’s website and iOS/Android apps, including search and family/org views.
4. **That** automated fetching of those public pages (or a named API) is allowed for that purpose.
5. **Commercial / public reuse** if their terms currently ban it (NSDA/Tabroom especially).
6. **What is out of scope** if they care: no participant PII, no problems, no logos unless separately granted.
7. **Revocation**: they can withdraw; we stop the feed and unpublish those rows.

Store the file off-git (email archive). In product, record the date in `lib/ingestion-sources.ts` field `permissionReviewedOn` and only then enable the adapter or env gate. Tabroom already uses `TABROOM_WRITTEN_PERMISSION=1`.

Priority

Reach here means “how many real student events become searchable,” not how pretty the brand is.

Priority	Why it is first	Ask
P1	One feed would change a whole category	NSDA / Tabroom; Alliance for Young Artists & Writers (Scholastic); MATHCOUNTS; FIRST
P2	Second calendar or official API in the same category	SpeechWire; MAA (AMC/AIME/USAMO); REC Foundation / VEX Events; Society for Science fair finder
P3	Smaller national programs; still blocked or ToS-unclear	YoungArts; NSDA.org membership calendars (if anything useful is not on Tabroom)
Later	Affiliate layer—same decision as USCF state affiliates	State speech associations (CHSSA and peers); Science Olympiad / TSA state sites; NSDA districts

National Science Bowl is **already live** from DOE public pages. Do not ask DOE for a scrape license unless legal wants a courtesy letter on file.

Must have written permission (blocked today)

These are the emails that actually increase reach. Causey already treats them as paused, blocked, or link-only.

1. National Speech & Debate Association — Tabroom (P1)

Site	https://www.tabroom.com/index/index.mhtml , https://www.speechanddebate.org/
Why	Almost every real NSDA-circuit tournament (national, district, local invitational) lives here. Same role TLA plays for chess. Without this, debate search stays Texas UIL invitationals only.
Blocker	NSDA terms cover Tabroom: no automated access; downloads limited to personal non-commercial viewing; no commercial/public reuse. <code>robots.txt</code> allowing calendar paths does not override that. Adapter exists but is paused (migration 0051, <code>TABROOM_WRITTEN_PERMISSION</code>).
Ask	Written license to fetch public tournament list/detail pages and republish factual listing metadata on Causey (web + apps), with attribution and a link to Tabroom. Explicitly include automated access and public reuse.
Do not ask for	Membership-only pages, ballots, entries, results, judge or student PII, Tabroom as a tab system.
If they say no	Keep the outbound Tabroom link. Do not rebuild the old Texas scrape. SpeechWire is not a substitute we can use without its own yes.
Status	Not contacted

2. Alliance for Young Artists & Writers — Scholastic Art & Writing Awards (P1)

Site	https://www.artandwriting.org/
Why	Largest national arts and writing umbrella (many categories). Closest analogue to a federation for that space.
Blocker	Terms prohibit automated indexing. Link-only in product.
Ask	Permission to index public program/affiliate deadline listings (or a data feed they already publish). National + regional affiliate dates if they want students to find local affiliates.
Do not ask for	Student work, judging, accounts, or logos unless they offer brand guidelines separately.
If they say no	Stay on TAEA VASE, UIL arts, AFSA, Bennington.
Status	Not contacted

3. MATHCOUNTS (P1)

Site	https://www.mathcounts.org/ — chapter/state competition search
Why	Middle-school math, chapter → state → national. Dense, recurring, school-shaped.
Blocker	Terms require prior written consent to reproduce, retransmit, or republish site materials.
Ask	Written consent to republish public competition search results (name, dates, location, official URL) on Causey.
Do not ask for	Contest problems, school rosters, or the coaching portal.
Status	Not contacted

4. FIRST (FRC / FTC / FLL) (P1)

Site	https://www.firstinspires.org/
Why	Robotics at every school age band; regional → championship. STEM has no single umbrella; this is one of the largest independent circuits.
Blocker	Official API needs a token and use appropriate to the product . Do not scrape logged-in event tools.
Ask	API credentials (or a public event feed) for event listings only , for display in a student discovery app, with their required attribution. Confirm commercial/public display is in scope.
Do not ask for	Team PII, scoring, or bypassing FIRST account rules.
Status	Not contacted

5. SpeechWire (P2)

Site	https://www.speechwire.com/
Why	Second debate/speech host. Some circuits never appear on Tabroom. Worth it after or in parallel with NSDA—check overlap once both are legal.
Blocker	Terms prohibit automated indexing.
Ask	Same factual-listing license as Tabroom, limited to public calendars.
Do not ask for	Tabulation, ballots, or student data. Never fetch SpeechWire as a side effect of a UIL (or other) scrape.
Status	Not contacted

6. Mathematical Association of America — AMC / AIME / USAMO (P2)

Site	https://maa.org/amcreg/
Why	The high-school math pathway. Dates are public; we still do not republish them.
Blocker	Site-wide Terms of Use returned HTTP 403 to ordinary access during review (August 2026). Causey does not assume for-profit public reuse is allowed.
Ask	Written permission to display published AMC/AIME/USAMO (and AMC 8 if they want) dates and official URLs, plus a copy of or pointer to the terms that allow it.
Do not ask for	Problems, scores, or student registration data.
Status	Not contacted

7. REC Foundation — VEX Events (P2)

Site	https://events.vex.com/robot-competitions/vex-robotics-competition ; PDF also cites roboticseducation.org / vexrobotics.com
Why	Separate robotics circuit from FIRST; grades split; regionals → worlds. Adapter already exists.
Blocker	Ordinary public HTML still returns HTTP 403 (Cloudflare), re-checked 2026-09-02. Causey will not bypass that. RobotEvents is not the official 2026–27 pathway.
Ask	Either: (a) allowlisted crawler / official listing API, or (b) confirmation that public directory HTML will return ordinary 200s to our documented user agent. Written reuse of listing metadata either way.
Do not ask for	Permission to break Cloudflare. Do not scrape RobotEvents as a substitute.
Status	Not contacted

8. Society for Science — fair finder (P2)

Site	https://findafair.societyforscience.org/
Why	Science-fair geography (ISEF affiliates). Complements TXSEF (Texas state only) and DOE Science Bowl (national dates only).
Blocker	Product is link-only pending permission for automated indexing.
Ask	Index public fair finder rows (name, dates, location, official URL) or a sanctioned export.
Status	Not contacted

9. YoungArts (P3)

Site	https://youngarts.org/
Why	Multi-discipline, ages 15–18, more selective than Scholastic. Smaller reach, same legal pattern.
Blocker	Terms prohibit automated indexing.
Ask	Public application-cycle dates and discipline list only.
Status	Not contacted

10. NSDA.org (membership calendars) (P3)

Site	https://www.speechanddebate.org/
Why	National body; some calendar content is membership-gated. Tabroom is the high-value ask; this is only if they want a public NSDA.org calendar indexed as well.
Blocker	Do not scrape behind login.
Ask	Point us at any public HTML or feed they want indexed; or fold it into the Tabroom license.
Status	Fold into the NSDA/Tabroom conversation

Confirm before building (not blocked yet)

These were on the competition-sources list. Causey has **no adapter** and **no completed permission review**. Do not treat them as “free to scrape.” Do a robots + terms pass first; send a courtesy letter if terms are silent, commercial-use is fuzzy, or the org is large enough that surprise indexing would be a bad start.

Org	URL	What a yes would unlock	Ask / confirm
National Catholic Forensic League (NCFL)	Search from “The NCFL” / ncfl.org	Parallel Catholic national + district structure (not NSDA)	Public national/district dates only; no membership pages
National Parliamentary Debate Association (NPDA)	https://npdadebate.com	College / some high-school-adjacent parli calendar	Public calendar page
Science Olympiad	https://www.soinc.org/	National tournament + pointer to state sites	National dates first; state portals only with a second pass
Technology Student Association (TSA)	https://tsaweb.org	National conference; state delegations	National first
USA Computing Olympiad (USACO)	https://usaco.org	Online contest windows	Dates and official URL; no problems or logins
Envirothon	https://envirothon.org	State → national environmental science	National (and published state) dates
Poetry Out Loud (NEA + Poetry Foundation + state arts agencies)	https://www.poetryoutloud.org/	Recitation pathway, state → national	Public coordinator / national finals dates

Org	URL	What a yes would unlock	Ask / confirm
Bow Seat Ocean Awareness Contest	bowseat.org (confirm current URL)	One annual multi-media / writing cycle	Year-specific deadline, like AFSA
State speech associations (e.g. CHSSA)	Varies	State qualification layer (chess “state affiliate” analogue)	One national policy first: link directory vs per-state scrape. Do not send 50 emails until that policy exists.

If a confirm-before-building source has a clear public-domain or “no automation ban” page (DOE Science Bowl pattern), engineering can still require a recorded review date in `ingestion-sources.ts` without waiting on a letter. When in doubt, ask.

Do not ask (already live, or the wrong kind of source)

Source	Why not an outreach target
US Chess TLA, CCA, OnlineReg, Chess-Results, FIDE, Texas Chess Association	Already ingested. Production-use review for chess remains ops, not a new letter campaign.
DOE National Science Bowl	Live. Public-domain Office of Science pages; national dates only.
Purple Comet! Math Meet	Live.
Texas Science & Engineering Fair	Live (Texas state fair only).
UIL speech/debate, theatre, marching band	Live (Texas, stated coverage only).
TAEA VASE	Live.
AFSA essay, Bennington Young Writers	Live or waiting on a year-specific cycle.
MathWorks Math Modeling Challenge	Reference because 2027 dates are not published , not because of a scrape ban. Revisit when the first-party page has a complete window.
Scienteer, zFairs	Tenant software, not national directories.
RobotEvents	Not the official 2026–27 VEX pathway.
AoPS, NewPages	Secondary directories; Causey does not ingest them as official sources.
USCF state affiliate sites	Already a public reference directory . Per-state scrape is a later program, same as CHSSA-class debate affiliates.

Short email you can send

Subject: Permission to list public [Tabroom / MATHCOUNTS / ...] events on Causey

Hello,

Causey (<https://causey.dev>) is a student competition discovery app. Chess listings are the furthest along; we are careful about other sources and do not scrape sites that forbid automation or public reuse.

We would like written permission to fetch your **public** [tournament calendar / competition search / event API] and display factual listing information for students, families, coaches, and schools: event name, dates, location or online, eligibility and fees only when you already publish them, and a link to your official page. We would not collect participant data, contest content, or ballots, and we would not use your logo unless you grant that separately.

Fetching would be polite and infrequent (on the order of twice a week), with an identifiable user agent. You could revoke permission and we would stop the feed.

If this is in scope, a short email from someone who can grant it—plus any attribution or trademark rules—is enough for us to keep on file. Happy to jump on a call.

Thank you,

[Name]

Causey

Customize the bracketed source. For FIRST, say **API token for event listings**, not HTML scrape. For VEX, say **ordinary access or an official listings API**, not a Cloudflare workaround.

After a yes

1. File the letter off-git; note date and grantor here and in `permissionReviewedOn`.
2. Re-check `robots.txt` and current terms the same week (landscapes shift).
3. Scope the adapter like existing non-chess feeds: official HTML or named API only, exact dates or no row, no invented regionals, no third-party registration hosts.
4. Enable the existing env/admin gate only for that source (Tabroom: `TABROOM_WRITTEN_PERMISSION=1` plus restoring dispatch). Do not treat one org's yes as permission for another.
5. Keep site-wide product copy honest: still incomplete coverage, confirm with the organizer.

Tracking

Org	Pri.	Last contact	Grantor / date	Outcome	Engineering gate
NSDA / Tabroom	P1				TABROOM env gate
Scholastic (Alliance)	P1				new adapter after yes
MATHCOUNTS	P1				new adapter after yes
FIRST	P1				API token + adapter
SpeechWire	P2				new adapter after yes
MAA AMC	P2				new adapter after yes
VEX / REC	P2				200s or API; vex_events_scrape
Society for Science	P2				new adapter after yes

Org	Pri.	Last contact	Grantor / date	Outcome	Engineering gate
YoungArts	P3				new adapter after yes
NCFL	Confirm				
NPDA	Confirm				
Science Olympiad	Confirm				
TSA	Confirm				
USACO	Confirm				
Envirothon	Confirm				
Poetry Out Loud	Confirm				
Bow Seat	Confirm				
State speech affiliates	Later				policy first, then per state